

Dolly (Yang) Yu

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EDUCATION

Yale University

Expected May 2027

PhD in Financial Economics

- **Field:** Household Finance, Financial Innovation, Corporate Finance
- **Relevant Courses:** Econometrics, Financial Economics, Corporate Finance, Empirical Methods
- **Teaching Fellowship:** Household Finance (PhD), Personal Finance (MBA), Fixed Income Securities I (MBA), Capital Markets (MBA)

Yale University

08/2018 – 05/2019

Master of Arts in International and Development Economics

High Distinction

University of Toronto, St. George Campus

09/2014 – 06/2018

Honors Bachelor of Science in Economics and Statistics

CGPA: 3.90/4.00

- **Awards & Honors:**
New College Council In-Course Scholarship – 08/2016
Dean's List Scholar – 2015 Summer, 2016 Winter, 2018 Winter

PROJECTS & RESEARCH

The Shadow Cost of the Credit Limit: Payment Choice and Liquidity Hoarding

- With Jose Murillo (Primerio AI)
- Investigate how the shadow cost of borrowing limits drives high-frequency payment choices, exploiting transaction-level variation in real-time credit utilization, consumption baskets, and credit limit changes.
- Develop a theoretical framework of precautionary payment choice and exploit quasi-experimental credit limit changes to quantify the welfare and default implications of real-time liquidity management.

Earned Wage Access, Financial Health and Employee Retention

- With Boris Vallee (INSEAD) and Jose Murillo (Primerio AI)
- *Selected for the 2023 NBER Innovative Data in Household Finance, MFA 2026, and SGF 2026*
- Investigate the underlying economic mechanisms that drive the usage patterns of the Early Wage Access (EWA) product documented using proprietary company data.
- Estimate the relative value of EWA under standard household preferences and identify the source for potential economic value for employees and employers.

Riding the Waves: Geographic Diversification and Bank Responses to Local Funding Shocks

- With Wei Li (UIBE) and Mingmei Liu (JNU)
- *Selected for the 2025 EWMES and 2025 Sydney Banking and Financial Stability Conference*
- Exploit a segment of Chinese wealth management products (WMP) to isolate demand-side funding shocks from asset-side considerations, documenting a 60% pass-through of local inflation shocks to yields.
- Demonstrate large banks' geographic footprint enables active, high-frequency liability reallocation across regions via internal capital markets, with greater yield response than smaller banks and significant cross-regional hedging behavior.

The Economics of Rent-to-Own Housing

- Document product features and usage patterns of rent-to-own customers utilizing proprietary company data.
- Evaluate the optimality conditions for using rent-to-own contracts by calibrating housing choice model.

Mortgage Securitization and Housing Affordability

- With Daojing Zhai (Yale)
- Establish the link between rise of institutional investors in the single-family rental market and small-dollar mortgage shortage and discuss the falling convenience premium of private securitization as a channel in the post-crisis era.

Case Materials

A Case in Point: Shared Home Equity

10/2020

- With Boris Vallee (HBS), Daniel Green (HBS) and Sid Beaumaster (HBS). *Harvard Business School Case 221-026*
- Analyze shared home equity as an alternative household home-buying financing option by comparing the product of a home equity start-up and traditional access to capital.

Seso Global: Building a Blockchain-enabled Property Marketplace in Nigeria

02/2020

- With Boris Vallee (HBS). *Harvard Business School Case 220-055*
- Discuss the challenges and opportunities of reinventing the real estate ecosystem in a developing economy by examining the business model of a Blockchain startup.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Harvard Business School

07/2019 – 06/2021

Research Associate to Professor Boris Vallee and Jonas Heese

- Collected and manipulated raw data and synthesized databases to provide summary statistics and data exhibits for academic articles and presentations;
- Interpreted regression results and made recommendations to faculty regarding research methodologies and statistical tests;
- Collaborated to write cases and supplemented tasks such as interviewing the protagonists, background research, writing and producing exhibits.

Chang'an International Trust

05/2016 – 07/2016

Summer Intern

Qingdao, China

- Engaged with 20 clients to understand their financial needs and presented suitable product offerings;
- Conducted research on market trends and developments and presented key findings at each morning meeting;
- Prepared comprehensive reports from analyzing performance metrics and summarizing due diligence reports to target potential clients.

COMMUNITY SERVICES

Economic Students' Association, Mentorship Program

09/2017 – 05/2018

Mentor

UTChinese Network

02/2015 – 06/2016

Deputy Director of Sponsorship

SKILLS

Programming: Stata, R, Matlab, Python, LaTeX, MS Office

Language: Chinese (Native), English (Proficient), Korean (Intermediate)

COMMITTEE MEMBERS

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